

# Jake Rayner

## UX & Product Design Lead

Manchester • jake.rayner.96@gmail.com • +44 7733 361372

## Professional Summary

I'm a UX and product designer with over 10 years' experience working on digital products across a range of industries such as automotive, e-commerce, fintech and online gaming, including previous roles at Bentley Motors and Aston Martin Lagonda.

For the past three years I've led UX at Debenhams Group, setting up the UX function after the Debenhams acquisition and scaling it across all 21 brands within the group, designing industry-leading experiences whilst optimising for technical synergies and high-velocity delivery in a fast-paced industry.

## Experience

### Debenhams Group - UX Designer

Aug 2023 - Present

- Defined and launched a new Debenhams UX function post-acquisition, establishing design processes, principles and a cross-functional operating model for the digital product and technology team.
- Grew the team from a single brand (Debenhams) into a Group-wide UX function covering 21 brands, including Debenhams, boohoo, boohooMAN, PrettyLittleThing, Karen Millen, Nasty Gal, Coast, Oasis, Warehouse, Dorothy Perkins, Burton and more.
- Became the single most senior point of contact for UX/UI across the business, setting UX direction and representing UX cross-functionally, coordinating priorities and requirements from different brands and departments across the Debenhams Group to define the UX roadmap and deliverables.
- Established a bi-weekly alignment forum with the e-commerce and creative leads from every brand in the group, covering design reviews, feedback and feature sign-off, alongside a monthly collaboration and innovation session focused on longer-term ideation.
- Built and scaled a unified design system of 1000+ components for 21 brands whilst retaining individual brand identities, maintained by a team of two designers and adopted by 50+ developers across multiple locations.
- Built a layered token system that themes all 21 brands from one source through a single brand attribute, covering shared component families and a 130+ icon library with no manual overrides in design or code.
- Cut design and delivery timelines for new features across all brands from months to days, while migrating more brands from the group onto a single unified tech stack and improving output quality and operational efficiency with small, lean design and development teams.
- Led the rapid design, prototyping and development of industry-leading features, including virtual try-on, visual search, AI-powered e-commerce agents and recommendation capabilities, social-integrated shopping experiences, a new streamlined checkout, and third-party services such as personalisation, insurance, click and collect and delivery protection.
- Led WCAG and ADA accessibility audits and remediation across group brands, collaborating with the legal department and helping the business avoid payouts from attempted US accessibility litigation.
- Developed an AI-assisted design workflow with Claude, Claude Code and Figma MCP, building high-fidelity prototypes in hours rather than weeks on the same technologies as the live product, which also proves technical feasibility early.
- Drove a continuous group-wide CRO programme of 100+ A/B tests over three years, run per project across the group's brands, measuring conversion rate, AOV, revenue per user and checkout completion to statistical confidence. Some example tests included:
  - New Shop By Fit functionality (+11.7% conversion on Karen Millen)
  - AI-generated review summaries on PDP (+2.3% conversion and +1.5% revenue per user)
  - Bag product recommendation optimisations (+2.2% conversion on Debenhams)
  - Checkout address CTA redesign (+1.8% conversion)

- Click & Collect checkout optimisations (collect conversion up from 3.5% to 4.1%, reducing supply chain costs)

## **Aston Martin Lagonda - Project (Lead) UX/UI Designer**

2021 - July 2023

- Led a UX/UI team of five (two senior designers, two senior researchers and a motion graphics specialist), working with product, EE, interior design, the C-suite and external suppliers.
- Worked on the full model-line refresh, starting with DB12 and continuing through the new Vantage, DBX707 and Valhalla, covering the end-to-end interior HMI: the central infotainment touchscreen, digital instrument cluster, steering wheel switchgear and centre console controls, plus the connected car experience across native iOS and Android apps. This included the new in-house infotainment system that replaced the previous Mercedes-Benz-sourced system.
- Led the planning and execution of customer research, prototyping, design and user validation testing within the R&D function, with a focus on HMI, native iOS and Android apps.
- Designed and validated information architecture, wireframes, interaction flows, prototypes and final UI across the connected car app, website, configurator and infotainment system through both online moderated and unmoderated usability studies as well as in-person focus groups at select dealer locations in the USA.
- Conceptualised, defined, built and maintained Aston Martin's first digital design system, derived from a new brand refresh, ensuring consistency across the in-car and mobile/desktop/wearable connected interfaces.
- Managed external agencies, suppliers, partners and contracted UX/UI specialists, acting as the bridge between internal strategy from the C-suite and senior leadership, and external execution and delivery.
- Ran monthly alignment sessions with the C-suite, internal department leads and external partners to review progress, gather feedback and estimate upcoming projects.
- Conducted benchmarking and competitor analysis, independently and with industry partners such as Screens and SBD Automotive, and presented research, design concepts and progress to the C-suite and senior leadership on a regular basis.
- Partnered with the digital, sales and marketing teams on the website and the new multi award-winning configurator (including 1st place in the Marketing category at Best of Consulting 2022), used by more than half of customers during their purchase journey and by dealers on the 35ft screen at Q New York, the brand's Park Avenue flagship.
- Connected the journey end to end: the website and configurator create each customer's Salesforce CRM profile and Aston Martin account at the first touchpoint, and that same account carries their order and build details into the app and on to the car's HMI at delivery.

## **Bentley Motors - UX/UI Designer**

2018 - 2021

- Supported the Digitalisation and Innovation team in the execution of Bentley's digital transformation.
- Designed, maintained and developed Bentley's first UX playbooks and design systems across internal and customer-facing native iOS and Android apps.
- Led UX/UI for Bentley's two core customer-facing apps, My Bentley and The Bentley Network App, delivering several new iterations and features that brought both in line with the brand guidelines and new UX playbook/design system.
- Worked with VW Group supplier Quartett Mobile on My Bentley, built on the same technology as the Porsche and Audi apps, running workshops at their Munich office to define shared functionality, identify where Bentley could differentiate, and test on their connected HMI rigs, in alignment with key stakeholders from EE and Sales & Marketing.
- Designed early concepts for connectivity and infotainment features and functions, alongside a broad range of internal enterprise and B2B apps across native iOS and Android.
- Supported Bentley's senior leadership in defining the Beyond100 strategy and vision.
- Helped develop a new digital talent pipeline and recruited and mentored 18 digital apprentices, and worked with Manchester Metropolitan University to help establish the UK's first Digital UX degree apprenticeship, shaping the curriculum alongside other local employers such as the BBC.
- Collaborated with VW Group brands (Porsche, Lamborghini, Audi, SEAT, Skoda and more) on various projects and initiatives where group synergies aligned.

## **The Co-operative Bank - UX Designer**

2017 - 2018

- Led UX/UI design for the bank's new iOS and Android mobile banking app, and website, working with marketing, brand, research and business-wide stakeholders.

## **bet365 - UX/UI Designer**

2016 - 2017

- Helped transition bet365 from a graphic-focused web design team to a digital product UX/UI team during a period of industry transformation, introducing tools and processes that improved customer experience, satisfaction scores and revenue.
- Delivered features to 6 million daily active users across iOS, Android and web.

## **Barclays Mobile Banking - UX/UI Designer**

2015 - 2016

- Helped transition Barclays' design from external partners to a new in-house UX/UI capability for Barclays Mobile Banking, Barclaycard and Pingit, building the first mobile design language and UI kit.
- Delivered features that supported growth from 3 million to 6.5+ million active mobile banking users in under 12 months.

## **Barclays Innovation Team - UX/UI Designer & Creative Consultant**

2014 - 2015

- Designed early digital banking products and concepts across iOS, Android and web for Barclays and external partner organisations such as Childline and Microsoft (Windows Phone), alongside producing video, animation, print and digital creative work in a small in-house team.

# **Skills**

### **Research and validation**

discovery, moderated and unmoderated usability testing, focus groups and customer clinics, card sorting, tree testing, A/B testing and CRO, analytics and insight synthesis.

### **Experience design**

information architecture, user flows, interaction models and UI design, automotive HMI physical and digital interfaces, native iOS and Android, responsive web, WCAG accessibility.

### **Systems and prototyping**

multi-brand design systems and design tokens, component libraries, UX playbooks, high-fidelity and coded prototypes (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React).

### **AI-assisted design**

end-to-end AI workflows with Claude, Claude Code and Figma MCP, from discovery and benchmarking to prototyping and validation.

### **Leadership and strategy**

UX strategy and roadmaps, design operations and governance, workshop and forum facilitation, stakeholder management up to C-suite, team leadership and mentoring, agency management, agile delivery across rapid digital and long-cycle vehicle programmes.

### **Tools**

Figma, ProtoPie, Sketch, Illustrator, Photoshop, Premiere Pro, After Effects, Miro, Confluence, Jira, UserTesting, Maze, Claude, Claude Code

### **Education**

Diploma in Professional Competence for IT and Telecoms Professionals (QCF). A-Levels in Business Studies, Media Studies, Maths and Music.